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A-A-3178
December 02, 1998

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
MARKER, TUBE TYPE, VARIOUS

This General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. Scope: This Commercial Item Description covers tube type capillary action, bullet and conical shaped nib, solvent based presentation markers used with white boards and most other smooth or laminated surfaces and water based markers used for presentation flip charts.

2. Classification:

Type:	I.	Dry-Erase Set
	II.	Flip Chart Set
	III.	Arrow Point (Conical Tipped)
	IV.	Large Chiseled Tipped

3 Salient Characteristics:

3.1 Type I and II marker sets (4 each) shall be designed to operate by capillary action. The markers shall be constructed so as to provide good protection against evaporation and leakage. The markers shall be equipped with a tight-fitting protective cap or plug. The cap or barrel shall be colored which will indicate color of ink content. The set shall consist of the following colors: Black, Blue, Red, and Green, and shall contain a minimum of 3.5 to 4.0 grams of ink.

3.2 The overall length of type I and II markers (with the cap in place) shall not be less than 125 mm (4.9 inches) and no more than 175 mm (6.9 inches). The diameter shall not be less than 10 mm (.4 inches) and not more than 20 mm (.8 inches).

3.3 Metal or plastic used on type I and II markers shall be of a material appropriate for the intended purpose and when used externally shall be suitable for coating when used as a decorative finish.

3.4 The writing nib for type I and II markers shall be of any material suitable for the intended purpose. The nib shall be bullet shaped (3 mm to 10 mm) and shall permanently secured in position. The barrel for type I markers shall contain a solvent-based ink and type II shall contain a water-based non-toxic ink in accordance with ASTM D 4236 or ASTM D 236.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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3.5 Type I markers ink, shall be fed to the nip by capillary action and shall produce solid lines which will wipe off melamine, porcelain, glass, smooth metal and most clear laminates with a dry cloth or tissue. Type II markers ink, shall be fed to the nib by capillary action and shall not bleed through presentation easel paper.

3.6 Type III and IV markers shall be a non-refillable tube type designed to operate by capillary action. These markers shall be constructed so as to provide good protection against evaporation and leakage. Removal of the cap for up to fifteen hours (recuperation of 30 minutes) shall not affect the instruments marking ability.

3.7 Type III and IV markers ink shall be held within the marker by an absorbent material so that there is no free liquid within the marker. The ink shall not smudge when allowed to dry for more than three seconds when marking on plain bond paper.

3.8 Type III and IV markers shall be equipped with a tight-fitting plastic or metal protective cap and the over-all length (with the cap in place) shall not be less than 125 mm (4.9 inches) and no more than 175 mm (6.9 inches). The diameter shall be not less than 10 mm (.4 inches) and not more than 20 mm (.8 inches).

3.9 Type III and IV markers shall be furnished in the following colors; Black, Blue, Red, and Green, as specified in the contract or order. Metal or plastic used shall be of a material appropriate for the intended purpose and when used externally shall be suitable for coating when used as a decorative finish.

3.10 The marker barrel shall be made of plastic or metal or a combination of these materials, and constructed so that the ink will emerge only through the writing nib. The writing nib may be of any material suitable for the intended purpose. The nib shall be permanently secured in position.

3.11 The cap or body shall be colored, or have a colored marking to indicate the color of ink content or in accordance with normal commercial practice. The minimum writing distance for type III markers shall be 609 meters (2000 ft), and type IV markers shall be 914 meters (3000 ft).

3.12 The manufacturer's name or trademark shall be exhibited on the marker. Placement of these permanent markings shall be at the option of the manufacturer, provided they are prominently displayed.

3.13 **Shelf Life.** The markers shall be able to meet all the requirements of this purchase description from the time of delivery to a minimum of eighteen months (18) in storage, under normal storage conditions (horizontally). Suppliers shall replace, without cost to the government, all markers failing to meet this requirement.

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3.14 Workmanship. The markers shall be free from defects or imperfections of manufacture, which may affect their durability, appearance, and serviceability or present a hazard to the user. The surface of the marker shall be of uniform appearance and shall be free from rough, sharp edges, or burrs, blisters, scratches and other defects.

4. Regulatory Requirements: The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. Quality Assurance Requirements:

5.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description. Quality of the product sold to the government shall be equal to or better than the quality of the product sold by the manufacturer in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Performance Tests: Unless otherwise specified, the tests shall be conducted in an atmosphere of 23° ± 1.1 C. (73.5° ± 2° F) and at a relative humidity of 50% ± 4%. Testing for type I markers shall be conducted on the following surfaces: melamine, porcelain, glass, smooth metal or transparencies with the markers held at an angle approximately 50° from the horizontal and with a writing pressure so that the markings are clearly visible. Testing for types II, III, and IV markers shall be conducted on bond paper as specified.

5.2.1 Drying Time (Type I). Write a five-letter word (on one of the surfaces outlined in paragraph 4.3) utilizing a sample marker. Allow drying for 5 seconds. Utilizing a dry cloth or tissue, wipe the markings from the surface and examine. Markings shall be completely removed from the surface (without leaving color residue).

5.2.2 Drying Time (Types II, III & IV). Place a sheet of paper on a smooth, flat surface and partially cover with a second sheet of paper. Place a 115 gram weight 4.0 oz), approximately 31.75 mm (1.25 inches) in diameter, on top of the second sheet. Write a line on the exposed portion of the bottom sheet, allow to dry three seconds, and immediately draw the top sheet and the weight across the writing at a rate of approximately 101.6 mm (4.0 inches) per second. The writing shall not smear or smudge.

5.2.3 Erasure (Type I). Write a five-letter word (on one of the surfaces outlined in paragraph 4.3) utilizing a sample marker. Allow to dry for 5 seconds. Utilizing a dry cloth or tissue, wipe the markings from the surface and examine. Markings shall be completely removed from the surface (without leaving color residue)

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5.2.4 Write Test (Type I). Write a five-letter word, in two inch letters (on one of the surfaces outlined in paragraph 5.2) utilizing a sample marker. Allow drying for 5 seconds. The marker shall produce solid continuous lines free from breaks, splits, separations, and uneven concentrations with bright, marking. The marker reservoir will then be weighed empty and then with ink to measure the fill (3.5 to 4.0 grams).

5.2.4.1 Machine Write Test. The machine tests shall be conducted on a Anja W-10B, K&L machine broad tip marker tester, or equivalent, with parameters set according to the machine's specific testing procedures. Testing of the marker shall continue until the distance requirement is met or the marker fails to produce a solid continuous line.

5.2.5 Visibility (Type I). Write a five-letter word, in two inch letters (on one of the surfaces outlined in paragraph 4.3) utilizing a sample marker. Allow drying for 5 seconds. The markings shall be distinct and highly visible. The word shall be able to be read from a distance of 20 feet with normal sight.

6. Packaging:

6.1 Preservation, packing, palletization and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. Notes:

7.1 Applicable Documents. Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

7.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

7.1.2 Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) T479 method may be obtained from TAPPI, Technology Park, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, Georgia, 30348-5113.

7.1.3 Federal Standards and Specifications may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at 470 L'Enfant Plaza, SW Washington DC 20407.

7.1.4 Copies of the appropriate ASTM's may be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials at 100 Barr Harbor Dr., West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959.

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7.2 **National Stock Number Listing (NSN).** The following is a list of nsn's assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible nsn's associated with the CID.

Dry Erase
7520-01-383-7950

Flip Chart
7520-01-424-4858

Arrow Point
7520-01-424-4883
7520-01-424-4853
7520-01-424-4863
7520-01-424-4877

Large Chisel Tipped
7520-01-424-4849
7520-01-424-4870
7520-01-424-4880
7520-01-424-4855

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Activity:

Preparing
GSA-FSS

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions or amendments to this Purchase Description until further notice.

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